

HOSANNA

TEXT: Matthew 21:1-1(NKJV) *“As they approached Jerusalem and came to Bethphage on the Mount of Olives, Jesus sent two disciples, saying to them, “Go to the village ahead of you, and at once you will find a donkey tied there, with her colt by her. Untie them and bring them to me. If anyone says anything to you, tell him that the Lord needs them, and he will send them right away.” This took place to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet: “Say to the Daughter of Zion, ‘See, your king comes to you, gentle and riding on a donkey, on a colt, the foal of a donkey.’ ” The disciples went and did as Jesus had instructed them. They brought the donkey and the colt, placed their cloaks on them, and Jesus sat on them. A very large crowd spread their cloaks on the road, while others cut branches from the trees and spread them on the road. The crowds that*

went ahead of him and those that followed shouted, “Hosanna to the Son of David!” “Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!” “Hosanna in the highest!” When Jesus entered Jerusalem, the whole city was stirred and asked, “Who is this?” The crowds answered, “This is Jesus, the prophet from Nazareth in Galilee.”

INTRO: The first Palm Sunday was a grand event. A week later things were not so good.

The day of the Triumphal Entry was punctuated with shouts of Hosanna! Hosanna means “*Save us now.*” The people who were lining the streets had no doubt witnessed the many miracles of Jesus and decided that He was the King who had come to save them and they wanted Him to set up an earthly Kingdom then and there!

The scene was like a Super Bowl champion parade on steroids!

Unfortunately, in only a few days the chorus changed to “*Crucify Him!*”

Human flesh is fickle! The very people who were crying “*Hosanna*” were screaming, “*Crucify Him*” a few day’s later. How could this be?

The people had selfish expectations of Jesus and when He failed to meet those expectations, they abandoned Him in the most violent way imaginable. What are your expectations of Him and what would make you walk away from Him?

- Will you walk away as the result of the loss of a relationship?
- Will you walk away from Him because of the death of a family member?
- Will you forsake Him because of a financial reversal?

We see walking away from Him and crying “*Crucify Him*” as two different things but actually they are one and the same!

HOSANNA MEANS ULTIMATE SURRENDER

Palm Sunday teaches us a valuable lesson: Jesus will be our king by our surrender or by His future conquest:

- The “*Hosanna*” crowd surrenders to Him willingly...
- The “*crucify*” Him crowd will surrender to Him by force...

No matter what crowd you are in “***Every knee shall bow and every tongue shall confess...***”

We must decide today which team we are on. Is it the “*Hosanna*” or the “*crucify*” crowd?

HOSANNA DELIVERS FROM THE BOOT OF OPRESSION

In those days Israel was under Roman occupation. It was a situation that, as we might describe it, “*Chapped their hide.*”

- They resented gentile occupation...
- Their national ego was severely bruised...
- They were being over-taxed and micromanaged...
- They were desperate for a political leader to arise and deliver them...

They were looking for a king all right. They were looking for one to throw off Roman oppression and set up a mighty Jewish kingdom. The political climate was perfectly suited for someone like Jesus to deliver the people from beneath the boot of Roman oppression.

Many people want Hosanna to deliver them from the boot of oppression that is crushing their throat:

- Deliver them from the boot of addiction...
- Deliver them from the boot of financial dependency...
- Deliver them from the power of an oppressive relationship...
- Deliver them from the clutches of a health problem...

These people were expecting Jesus to cut the legs out from under the Roman Empire and when He didn't perform to expectations they came at Him with a hell inspired fervor.

Hosanna can deliver us from all the things I have mentioned but what He really wants is our hearts and our loyalty.

Let me ask you this – are we willing to serve Him and love Him if He chooses to do none

of the above? If so, He is truly Hosanna. If not, He is nothing more than a good luck charm!

CRYING HOSANNA (SAVE US NOW) IS A CONDITION OF THE HEART

Matthew 27:19-26 (NKJV) *“While Pilate was sitting on the judge’s seat, his wife sent him this message: “Don’t have anything to do with that innocent man, for I have suffered a great deal today in a dream because of him.” But the chief priests and the elders persuaded the crowd to ask for Barabbas and to have Jesus executed.*

“Which of the two do you want me to release to you?” asked the governor.

“Barabbas,” they answered. “What shall I do, then, with Jesus who is called Christ?” Pilate asked. They all answered, “Crucify him!” “Why? What crime has he committed?” asked Pilate. But they shouted all the louder, “Crucify him!” When Pilate saw that he was getting nowhere, but that

instead an uproar was starting, he took water and washed his hands in front of the crowd. “I am innocent of this man’s blood,” he said. “It is your responsibility!” All the people answered, “Let his blood be on us and on our children!” Then he released Barabbas to them. But he had Jesus flogged, and handed him over to be crucified.”

Wow! These people have gone from “Hosanna” to “Crucify Him” to “Let His blood be upon us and upon our children” in less than a week!

The cries of “Hosanna” were obviously never sincere! They were looking for a limited savior not total surrender.

What these people didn’t understand is that if Jesus had set up an earthly Kingdom His dominion would have been limited and temporary. By going to the cross “**His**

Kingdom would be unlimited and without end!”

What Jesus knew that they couldn't get their heads around is that Hosanna has more to do with an attitude than it does with an activity.

Some folks think because they prayed a sinners prayer when they were twelve that covers everything all the way to the grave! Hosanna (Save us now) is a past, present and future cleansing!

The work of the cross only happened once but the attitude of the cross spans:

- Generations...
- Cultures...
- Languages...
- Continents...
- Kingdoms...

Concerning the attitude of Hosanna the Apostle John wrote to the church of

Laodicea, Revelation 3:20 (NKJV) ***“Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in and eat with him and he with me.”*** Can you hear the tenderness in the invitation? He is not like an episode of COPS, carrying a battering ram ... *“Bad boys! What’cha ya gonna do when they come for you...?”*

With loving kindness and tender mercies
Hosanna is calling to us today!

- Today we may voluntarily open the door...
- Today we have the opportunity to invite Him in...
- Today we may receive Him as King...
- Today we may shout His praise and declare His lordship...

This is the path of surrender. It is not always a Lilly-lined path and it involves persecution for righteousness at times. It requires the

attitude of an overcomer to resist temptations and persevere in loyalty. But the eternal and present day rewards of surrender make rebellion an unconscionable option.

CONCLUSION:

I said earlier He is our king by surrender or by conquest. Consider the latter with me now.

The Apostle Paul wrote of Jesus, Philippians 2:9-11 (NKJV) ***“Therefore God exalted Him to the highest place and gave him the name that is above every name, that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth, and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.”***

In addition, the Apostle John reveals to us that although Jesus came at first meekly and on a colt, His second coming will be quite different. Revelation 19:11-15 (NKJV) ***“I***

saw heaven standing open and there before me was a white horse, whose rider is called Faithful and True. With justice He judges and makes war. His eyes are like blazing fire, and on His head are many crowns. He has a name written on Him that no man knows but He himself. He is dressed in a robe dipped in blood, and His name is the Word of God. The armies of heaven were with Him.”

For all who fail to sincerely make Him Hosanna in this present age He will be the warrior of all warriors at the end of the age!

What will you do with Hosanna today?